

Are you currently using contraceptives?

		MALE	FEMALE
Not using any	38	39	37
Male condoms	36	45	27
Oral pills	10	7	13
Sterilisation	9	5	12
Copper T/Similar products	5	2	7
Withdrawal method	5	4	7
Sterilisation	1	1	1
Others	2	1	2

All figures in per cent. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices.

PREVENTIVE MEASURES

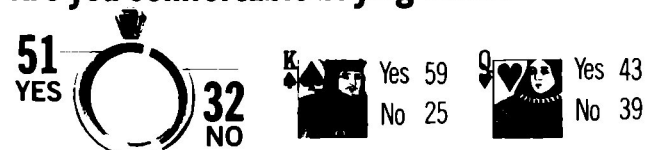
Seventy nine per cent of the respondents use contraceptives to postpone having children and 32 per cent of men use it to prevent passing on STDs/HIV. One-third of the total feel uncomfortable while buying contraceptives, Amitabh Bachchan asking for them in *Cheeni Kum* notwithstanding.

Why do you use contraceptives?

		MALE	FEMALE
To postpone having children	79	77	81
To prevent passing on STDs/HIV	24	32	15

All figures in per cent. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices.

Are you comfortable buying them?



All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

Who do you think should be responsible for family planning and contraception?

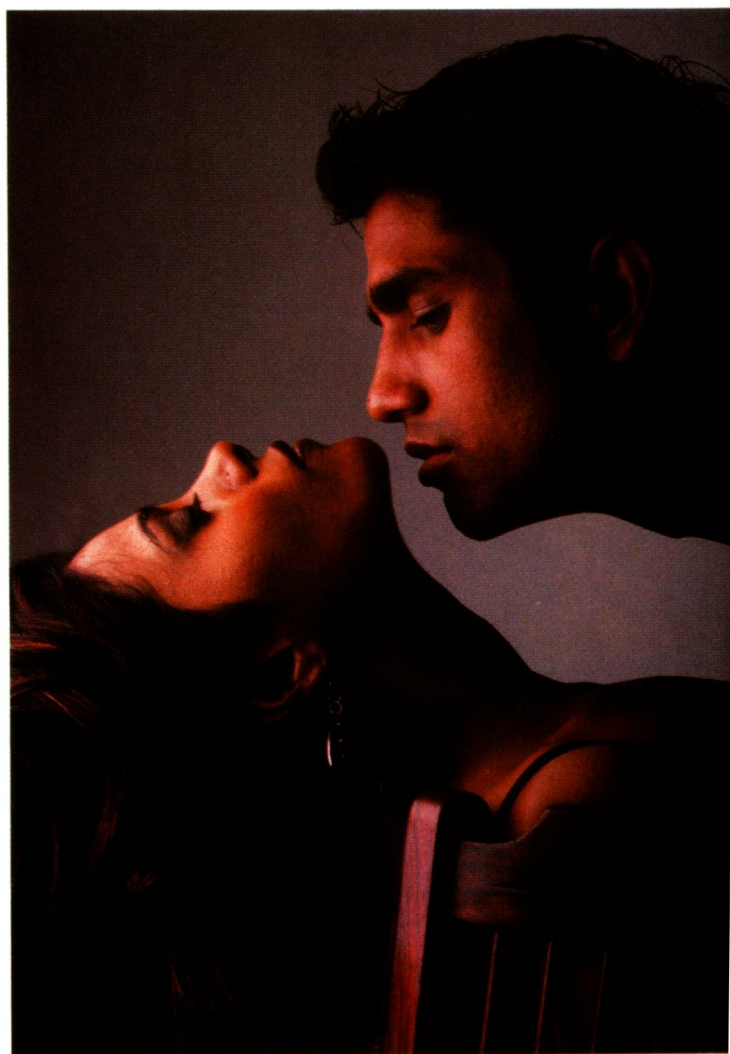
		MALE	FEMALE
Both husband and wife	68	66	71
Husband	18	21	16
Wife	11	12	10

All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

Did you plan your first child?



All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.



than it is elsewhere in India. Coming up with an average monthly coital frequency of 10.2, excluding the exceptional case of a couple who had relations only once or twice a year, Ghurye urged that this figure, based on present practice, must be treated as an underestimation. Many of his respondents had spoken quite wistfully of higher levels of performance in their "younger days".

In Ghurye's account, one material fact of life that posed a challenge to theory, methodology and statistical analysis was the occurrence of the wife's monthly period. To begin with, marital relations could not be initiated until after the wife's puberty. But even

thereafter, Ghurye hypothesised that the unexplained delay in consummation in some cases might be accounted for by the "vestiges of old custom" whereby, "according to the orthodox Hindu custom, sex-life can begun only during the first 16 days of the monthly period." Thereafter, the taboo on sex during menstruation left only 24 days or three and a half weeks from which to estimate average monthly frequency of intercourse. Today, it seems that neither the scientific community nor the public wishes to be reminded of nature's rhythms. Contemporary surveys make no mention of this simple fact of life, however prominent it might be in real-life coital